

REPORT

Most of the time, walking is merely practical, an unconsidered locomotive means between two sites. To make walking into an investigation, a ritual, a meditation, it becomes a certain subset of walking, physiologically like and philosophically unlike the way the mail carrier brings the mail. The subject of walking is, in some sense, about how we invest universal acts with particular meanings.

The meaning of this exercise was based upon the fact that, as a newly arrived outsider, I desired to create relations and meaning to the apparatus of Porto and specifically Bonfim, akin to my interest in understanding how social, economic, and physical environments can influence peoples well-being.

Population health and happiness is greatly shaped by the physical and socioeconomic characteristics of the places where individuals live. These characteristics are constantly evolving, and any local, national or transnational process that accelerates territorial transformations can ultimately have important consequences for the health of the population. Informed by the ideas of Careri on walking and its impact on contemporary culture and society in Rome, Italy in 2016, I embraced the nature and focus of the transformational act

of walking and endorsed my instincts and latent thoughts to comprehend the interconnected factors of Bonfilms character in the end 2022. I initiated each journey with the intention of saluting streams of consciousness and unstructured, as-sociative conclusions from Bonfilms environmental triggers. With no specific object or situation to capture, no destination, I captured what became evident to me. The only limits were the limits imposed by the map of Bonfilm.

By walking, I listened in a deeper way. When we give ourselves to places, they give us back, the more one comes to know them, the more one seeds them with the invisible crop of memories and associations, while new places offer up new thoughts, new possibilities. As Careri mentions in his piece Walkscapes – Walking as an Aesthetic Practice, the aim is to indicate walking as an aesthetic tool capable of describing and modifying those metropolitan spaces that often have a nature still demanding comprehension, to be filled with meanings rather than designed and filled with things. The things, objects, or rather, remainders left, so crude and bare in the streets, were exposed to conjecture. The residue and debris serve as decay for re-emergence. The old decay stands in balance with natures decay.

Reflections about purity and pollution seem to be like reflections about order and disorder, form and formlessness, being and non-being. Hence, nothing is dirty in itself, dirt only exists because, as matter out of place, it lies outside and

threatens the social system. (Williams & Bendelow, 1998). I ponder how decay and wickedness are close enough to the present to mirror an alternative past/present/future. A neglected factory testifies to a failed past but also reminds us that the future may end in ruin.

These captures were attentively assembled parallel to particular periods of consumption such as Black Fridays and Christmas. Operating during that context, I desired to purposefully show the ruin, liminal space, the leftover, the unwanted, in order to emphasize the contradiction between the land of pampered culture targeted within Portos branding and general parade of consumption and the actual individuals affected. Bonfilms physical liminality to the commercial centre further enabled this objective.

The choice to use a point-and-shoot camera should emphasize the impromptu nature of the scene with a seemingly random, and unplanned, effect. The feeling of immediacy received from the lack of formal crispness can draw the viewers awareness to the possibility of a hidden record. I intended to lure the viewer to relate to the figures and question their conditions. In doing so, I took insight into the works and ideas of Victor Burgin. According to Burgin, no experience of the city can be passive, for being only an observer means denying ones significance as a recorder of a shared experience. Existing within the scene and faced with the task of recording,

the contemporary artist must cope with the role played by his own personal perspective.

The inherent complexity created by the rough aspect of the imagery urges to indicate a move toward a complex referentiality and a kind of political art, which is confirmed upon noticing a socially-responsible narrative substance in the works themselves.

Georg Lukcs (1885-1971), a Hungarian Marxist philosopher, literary historian, critic, and aesthetician appreciated the manner in which an extension of the description of the modern city, usually devoted to documentation and verisimilitude, could begin to answer more philosophical questions regarding how human perception could be revealed through aesthetics. He understood the ability of art to contribute to peoples understanding of social relationships beyond what was readily perceivable in everyday life. Kralyfalui (1985). When discussing Victor Burgins work, Paul Smith, discusses Burgins development of what he calls double space, suggesting that the artist wishes to create a kind of dialectic confusion: a comment about the cooperation of internal and external space.

The decision to make use of black and white film (ILFORD HP5 Plus & ILFORD PAN 400) stands in accordance with a sort of digital fatigue. A means that is dissident and fronts the other side, the technological, modern side. Moreover, the digital is defined as the one dividing in two, while the analogue

is defined as two coming together as one. As the one dividing in two, the digital describes processes of distinction or decision. By contrast, the analogue, as the two coming together as one, describes the processes of integration or balance. The analogue brings together heterogeneous elements into identity. This is parallel to what I urge to do with my work and reflection of the urban space and coming into touch with other peoples beliefs and messages.

Careri, Francesco. Walkscapes: Walking as an Aesthetic Practice. Barcelona: Editorial Gustavo Gili. 2002.

Williams, Simon Johnson, and Gillian A. Bendelow. The Lived Body: Sociological Themes. Embodied Issues. Routledge. 1998.

Paul Smith. Double Space: On Victor Burgin. Cultural Studies and Critical Theory.

Kralyfalui, Bela (1985). Georg Lukcs or Bertolt Brecht?. British Journal of Aesthetics.
25. Autumn. p. 344.